SPERT® Story Map: Connect AI

User Guide

Pair a compatible AI assistant with your story map to build and edit structure in real time · storymap.spertsuite.com

WHAT IS CONNECT AI?

Connect AI is a feature in SPERT® Story Map that lets a compatible AI assistant build or edit your story map in real time. When the connection is active, the AI can create themes, backbones, and rib items, organize work into releases, and size unsized rib items on explicit request — all changes appear on your map as the AI works. You stay in control at every step: the AI asks what you want to build before doing anything, and you choose exactly what it can access.

Connect AI works through the **MCP protocol** (Model Context Protocol) — a standard for giving AI assistants access to external tools. SPERT Story Map hosts a dedicated MCP server at mcp.spertsuite.com that the AI calls to read and write your map structure. The AI assistant must be configured to reach this server before the feature can be used.

HOW IT WORKS — EACH SESSION

#	Action	Detail
1	Open a project and click Connect AI	The Connect AI button is in the project header, next to your product name. A consent modal appears.
2	Choose permissions	**Write Mode** (required) — the AI can create and edit themes, backbones, rib items, releases, and rib sizes. **Read Mode** (optional) — the AI can see your current map structure, release assignments, and rib sizes before making changes. Read Mode is required when asking the AI to allocate ribs to releases or size existing ribs. Click **Connect**.
3	Copy the pairing code and prompt	A short pairing code (e.g., CRANE-7842) appears alongside two copy buttons: **Copy Code** (the code alone) and **Copy Prompt** (a ready-to-paste message that includes the code and detailed instructions for the AI). The code expires in 15 minutes.
4	Paste the prompt into your AI assistant	Open your AI assistant — it must already be configured with the SPERT MCP server (see One-Time Setup). Paste the copied prompt and send it. The assistant will call the MCP server to claim the session, then ask you what product you are planning and which story map structure fits best before building anything.
5	Review and disconnect	Themes, backbones, rib items, and release assignments appear on your map in real time. Use Ctrl+Z to undo any AI action. Toggle **Read Mode** on or off from the Connect AI panel at any time. Click **Disconnect** when you are done — or the session expires automatically after 7 days.

Note: Do not switch projects while the AI is actively building — Connect AI is scoped to the project that was open when you clicked Connect. Rib items with sprint progress cannot be resized by either the AI or the Sizing board. To resize a locked rib, clear its progress first.

ONE-TIME SETUP: CONNECT YOUR AI CLIENT

Connect AI requires an AI client that supports MCP servers. Complete this setup once; every subsequent session starts at step 1 above. Seven clients work today:

claude.ai web (Pro / Max / Team / Enterprise)	Lowest-friction path for non-developers — no terminal or config file required. Free-tier accounts are not supported. In claude.ai, go to **Settings** → **Connectors** → **Add custom connector**. Paste the server URL: https://mcp.spertsuite.com No API key is needed — click Save. To use it: open a new conversation, confirm the SPERT connector is active, open SPERT Story Map in your browser, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.

Claude Code (CLI, any plan)	Best for developers — one command. Run once in any terminal: `claude mcp add --transport http spert-suite https://mcp.spertsuite.com` Add `--scope user` to make the server available across all projects (default is project-scope only). Confirm with `claude mcp list` — you should see spert-suite in the output. To use it: start a Claude Code session, open SPERT Story Map, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.
Claude Desktop (config file)	Requires Node.js (for npx). Locate the config file: on macOS, `~/Library/Application Support/Claude/claude_desktop_config.json`; on Windows, `%APPDATA%\Claude\claude_desktop_config.json`. Add the following to the **mcpServers** object (create the file if it does not exist): `"spert-suite": { "command": "npx", "args": ["mcp-remote", "https://mcp.spertsuite.com"] }` Save the file and restart Claude Desktop. mcp-remote installs automatically on first run.
Grok (paid tiers)	Self-service on all paid Grok tiers — similar UX to claude.ai Connectors. Go to grok.com/connectors → **New Connector** → **Custom** → paste https://mcp.spertsuite.com. No authentication required — click Create. To use it: open a Grok conversation, open SPERT Story Map in your browser, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.
ChatGPT (Pro / Team / Enterprise / Edu, Developer Mode)	Requires Developer Mode to be enabled. On **Pro** plans, go to **Settings** → **Apps & Connectors** → **Advanced** → **Developer Mode** → **On**. On **Business / Enterprise / Edu** plans, a workspace admin must enable it from Workspace Settings → Permissions & Roles → Connected Data. Once enabled, add the server: click **+** in a conversation → More → paste https://mcp.spertsuite.com, no authentication. To use it: open SPERT Story Map in your browser, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt into the ChatGPT conversation.
Copilot Studio (Microsoft 365, advanced)	In a Copilot Studio agent, go to **Tools** → **New tool** → **Model Context Protocol**, paste https://mcp.spertsuite.com, set Authentication to **None**, and click Create. Use the agent's Test panel to interact. Requires a Microsoft 365 license. Note: this connects the Copilot Studio agent, not Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat directly — deploying to Copilot Chat requires additional admin configuration.
Gemini CLI (developer path)	Google's command-line AI tool supports MCP via a config file, similar to Claude Code. Add the SPERT server to your Gemini CLI settings file under the **mcpServers** key with the server URL https://mcp.spertsuite.com. To use it: start a Gemini CLI session, open SPERT Story Map, click Connect AI, and paste the Copy Prompt.

WHAT STILL DOESN'T WORK

Connect AI requires an AI client with MCP server support configured. If you paste the Copy Prompt into an AI that has no MCP connection, the assistant reads the tool-call instructions but has no actual channel to your story map — nothing changes in the app. In some cases the AI may even fabricate a response, describing a map it claims to have built. The tell: tool names like **resolve_session_code** appear in the reply, but your map stays empty.

Not supported today: Gemini web app (gemini.google.com) — no self-service custom MCP connector in the consumer interface yet (Gemini CLI works; the web app does not). Free-tier claude.ai accounts — Connectors require a paid plan. ChatGPT Free and Plus without Developer Mode enabled. Any other AI assistant without MCP support configured.

WHAT'S COMING

MCP adoption has moved quickly. Seven clients work today: Claude (claude.ai, Code, Desktop), ChatGPT, Grok, Copilot Studio, and Gemini CLI. The remaining gap for consumer users is the Gemini web app — there is no self-service custom MCP connector in the consumer Gemini web interface yet, though Gemini CLI works for developers via a config file.

As MCP adoption continues to expand, Connect AI will work with new clients automatically — no changes to the SPERT server or your workflow will be required. The same pairing-code workflow works across all supported clients today.

WRITE MODE, READ MODE & PRIVACY	
Write Mode (required)	Lets the AI create themes, backbones, and rib items, organize work into releases, and size unsized rib items on explicit request. Three bulk tools — **storymap_bulk_create_releases**, **storymap_bulk_allocate**, **storymap_bulk_size** — collapse N individual calls into one, critical for large maps and AI clients that yield between tool calls. The AI cannot delete items or modify progress data. Rib items with sprint progress cannot be resized by the AI or the Sizing board — clear progress first to unlock.
Read Mode (optional)	Shares a compact snapshot of your current map with the AI — structure, release assignments, and current rib sizes. No progress data, allocation percentages, assessment notes, or rib item notes are included. Read Mode is required when asking the AI to allocate ribs to releases or size existing ribs; leave it off when building from scratch. Toggle at any time from the Connect AI session panel.
Session data & expiry	Pairing codes are single-use and expire after 15 minutes. Session data (the ops queue and any Read Mode snapshot) is stored in Firebase and auto-purged after 7 days. Click Disconnect to end a session and delete the snapshot immediately. Full details at spertsuite.com/ai-privacy.
AI-built map limits	A single Connect AI session can build up to 5 themes, 10 backbones per theme, and 10 rib items per backbone — up to 500 rib items total. These limits apply only to AI-assisted building; the standard app has no structural size limits. Existing maps and all other editing tools are otherwise unchanged.
Tips & caveats	Enable Read Mode before asking the AI to edit an existing map, allocate work to releases, or size ribs — without it, the AI cannot see your current structure and may duplicate work. Undo (Ctrl+Z) works on all AI-generated content. Review the AI's output before saving a JSON backup, as Undo history resets on page refresh. Don't switch projects mid-session; Connect AI is scoped to the project open at the time you clicked Connect.